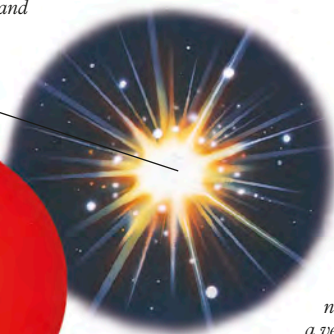
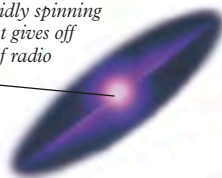




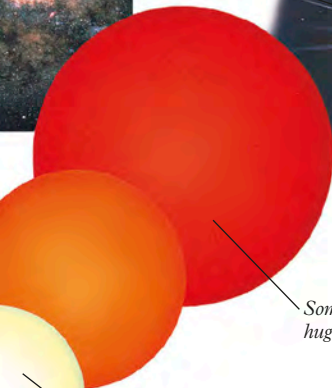
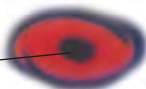
Sometimes a giant star explodes and is blown to pieces. This is called a supernova.



A supernova explosion sometimes results in a pulsar. A pulsar is a rapidly spinning star that gives off pulses of radio waves.

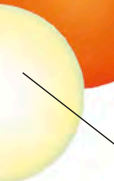


A black hole is not really a hole but a very tightly packed object with gravity so strong that not even light can escape.



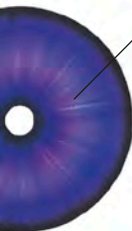
Some dying stars grow into huge red supergiants.

Massive stars shine very brightly, but do not live as long as smaller stars.



If seen through a telescope the star, with its gas shell, now looks like a planet, so it is called a planetary nebula.

Some stars gradually get smaller and whiter, until they become white dwarf stars.



Star spinner

Our galaxy, called the Milky Way, is a barred spiral galaxy. Our solar system is about two-thirds of the way out from the center, in one of the spiral arms. There are lots of galaxies in the universe and they have different shapes.



Our solar system is here.

Galaxies



A spiral galaxy



An elliptical galaxy



A barred spiral galaxy